



# Post-Construction Cleaning Checklist for Turnover

A phased checklist for moving a newly built or renovated commercial space from construction condition to occupancy-ready turnover.



Post-construction cleaning moves from controlled dust removal to detail work and a final readiness inspection.

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**Post-construction cleaning is a phased process: remove remaining debris safely, control fine dust, detail every finish, clean floors and glass, then inspect the space under final lighting. The work should follow contractor sequencing so completed areas are not repeatedly contaminated.**

## **Before cleaning begins**

Confirm that active construction is substantially complete and identify restricted areas, energized equipment, unfinished punch-list work and surfaces with special manufacturer instructions. Agree on who removes bulk construction debris, labels or protective films. Cleaning should not conceal defects that belong on the punch list.

## **Phase 1: controlled rough clean**

- Remove approved packaging and loose debris without damaging finishes.
- Vacuum or damp-remove dust from ledges, framing, casework and accessible overhead surfaces.
- Work high to low and toward controlled exits.
- Keep vents protected until the responsible trade authorizes removal.
- Report sharp objects, exposed wiring, leaks or unstable materials rather than handling them outside the cleaning scope.

Where respirable crystalline silica may be present, [OSHA's construction guidance](#) restricts dry sweeping or brushing when it could contribute to exposure and feasible alternatives are available. The competent contractor's exposure-control plan governs the site; appropriate HEPA or wet methods may be required.

## **Phase 2: detail clean**

Clean doors, frames, trim, shelving, cabinets, fixtures, interior glass and restroom surfaces using products compatible with the material. Remove

adhesive only with an approved method. Check corners, drawer interiors, hardware and horizontal surfaces that collect fine dust.

For renovation and turnover support, AMI's [commercial cleaning services](#) can be scoped by phase, access and final-use requirements.

## Phase 3: floors and final inspection

Vacuum carpet with suitable equipment. Clean resilient, tile or sealed floors according to manufacturer direction; do not assume a newly installed floor is ready for aggressive machine work or finish. Inspect with permanent lighting on, then recheck after remaining trades leave.

The turnover walk should cover:

- dust on high and low horizontal surfaces;
- streaks, labels and construction residue on glass;
- cabinets, closets and utility areas;
- restroom fixtures and dispensers;
- floor edges, transitions and corners;
- odors, moisture and unreported damage; and
- access cards, keys, alarms and lock-up procedure.

## Plan for re-cleaning risk

Final cleaning scheduled too early often becomes multiple cleanings. Coordinate painters, flooring installers, commissioning teams, furniture delivery and inspectors. Define an hourly or change-order process for new dust or damage after a zone has been accepted.

[Schedule an AMI turnover walkthrough](#) for a commercial project in Delaware, Eastern Maryland or Southeastern Pennsylvania.

## Frequently asked questions

### What is included in post-construction cleaning?

The exact scope varies, but commonly includes controlled dust removal, detail cleaning of fixtures and finishes, interior glass, floors, restrooms and a final quality check.

## **Does the cleaning company remove construction debris?**

Only if the contract assigns that work and the material can be handled safely. Bulk debris, hazardous material and trade waste should be explicitly allocated.

## **When should final cleaning be scheduled?**

After dust-producing work is complete and before occupancy, with enough time for inspection and touch-ups. Coordinate remaining trades to reduce recontamination.



# Walk the building. Then write the plan.

AMI scopes rooms, traffic, access, surfaces and standards before shift one across Delaware, Eastern Maryland and Southeastern Pennsylvania.

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## Exact live logo

Locked artwork from ami-cleaning.com. Spelling, geometry and colors are unchanged.

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